

Robby Cochran

Technical engineering leader - Security systems, Kubernetes, AI infrastructure, developer platforms
San Francisco, CA | kudzoo@gmail.com | robbycochran.com | github.com/robbycochran | linkedin.com/in/robertacochran

PROFILE

Technical engineering leader with a CS PhD, Staff-level systems/security depth, and people-management experience across startup and enterprise environments. Currently leads a team of five C++/Go/Rust engineers while driving product strategy in Kubernetes security, eBPF observability, developer platforms, and AI-agent infrastructure. Open to engineering leadership, Staff+/Principal, forward-deployed engineering, and founder-path roles where product judgment, customer proximity, and deep technical execution all matter.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Built and led StackRox/RHACS runtime-security product work from startup through Red Hat acquisition and OpenShift enterprise scale.
- Lead a five-engineer C++/Go/Rust team and shape product strategy across runtime security, platform support, customer requirements, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Led ACS agentic foundations: hackathon, CI tooling, support triage bots, skills strategy, secure harness primitives, and OpenShift execution paths.
- Current focus: runtime contracts, evaluation harnesses, observability, and policy controls for AI agent and developer infrastructure.

EXPERIENCE

IBM / Red Hat

Staff Engineer / Engineering Manager, Red Hat Advanced Cluster Security (RHACS)

2021 - Present

San Francisco, CA / Remote

- Led RHACS runtime-security roadmap spanning process activity, network security, file activity, behavioral baselines, runtime anomaly detection, Kubernetes-native policy workflows, and developer/analyst experience.
- Lead a team of five C++/Go/Rust engineers and balance people management, architecture, product strategy, and hands-on technical direction.
- Drove eBPF-based runtime visibility design for OpenShift/Kubernetes environments, including collection semantics, performance constraints, platform support, and low false-positive detection goals.
- Built secure AI-agent infrastructure through harness-openshell: declarative workflows, credential boundaries, inference routing, sandbox execution, and CI validation.
- Shaped OpenShift-first RHACS strategy around console integration, RBAC, GitOps/policy-as-code, runtime observability, and AI-assisted workflows.

StackRox, Inc. (acquired by Red Hat)

Staff Software Engineer / Senior Software Engineer / Member of Technical Staff

2017 - 2021

Mountain View, CA

- Joined an early-stage Kubernetes security startup and built runtime detection/enforcement features for containerized workloads and clusters.
- Advanced baseline-driven process/network visibility and links between observed runtime behavior and policy.
- Worked across product, engineering, and customer-driven security cases with large design partners through acquisition by Red Hat.
- Patent: US 11,811,804. Talk: BSidesSF 2018 - Listen to your Engine.

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

PhD Researcher, Computer Security and Software Verification

2008 - 2016

Chapel Hill, NC

- Developed symbolic client verification: server-side techniques for checking whether observed client traffic could have been produced by sanctioned software.
- Built symbolic-execution systems for games, cryptographic protocols, and distributed applications; refactored KLEE internals for parallelism.
- Publications: NDSS 2010 Best Paper / TISSEC 2011, NDSS 2013, and NSDI 2017.

Microsoft Research - Research in Software Engineering (RiSE)

Research Intern

Summer 2013

Redmond, WA

- Program synthesis via crowdsourcing; publication: POPL 2015 "Program Boosting"; patent: US 9,753,696.

Intel Corporation - Visual Computing Group

Software Engineer

2006 - 2007

Hillsboro, OR

- Built graphics-hardware analysis tooling to interpret, record, and replay Direct3D/OpenGL API calls for performance analysis of prototype visual-computing hardware.

EDUCATION

PhD, Computer Science, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, 2016 - Advisor: Michael K. Reiter. **BS, Computer Science**, Clemson University, Magna Cum Laude, 2006.

TECHNICAL DOMAINS

Runtime security; Kubernetes; OpenShift; RHACS; eBPF observability; behavioral baselines; policy-as-code; distributed systems; symbolic execution; software verification; formal methods; program synthesis; AI-agent safety; LLM gateways; MCP; Go; C/C++; Python; Rust; Bash; Docker; LLVM; SMT/SAT solvers.